

Django Social Media Platform

User Manual

Version 1.0

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1. Introduction

The **Django Social Media Platform** is a web application that allows registered users to maintain their profiles, create posts, share images, interact with posts through likes and comments, and manage their own content.

This manual explains how to use the features available in the current **v1.0** release.

The application currently provides:

- User registration and login
 - User profile management
 - Profile picture uploads
 - Post creation and management
 - Post image uploads
 - Likes and unlikes
 - Comments
 - User-owned content management
-

2. Getting Started

- Before using the application, the Django development server must be running.
- Once the application is started, open the development server address in a web browser.
- The application initially provides access to the authentication pages.

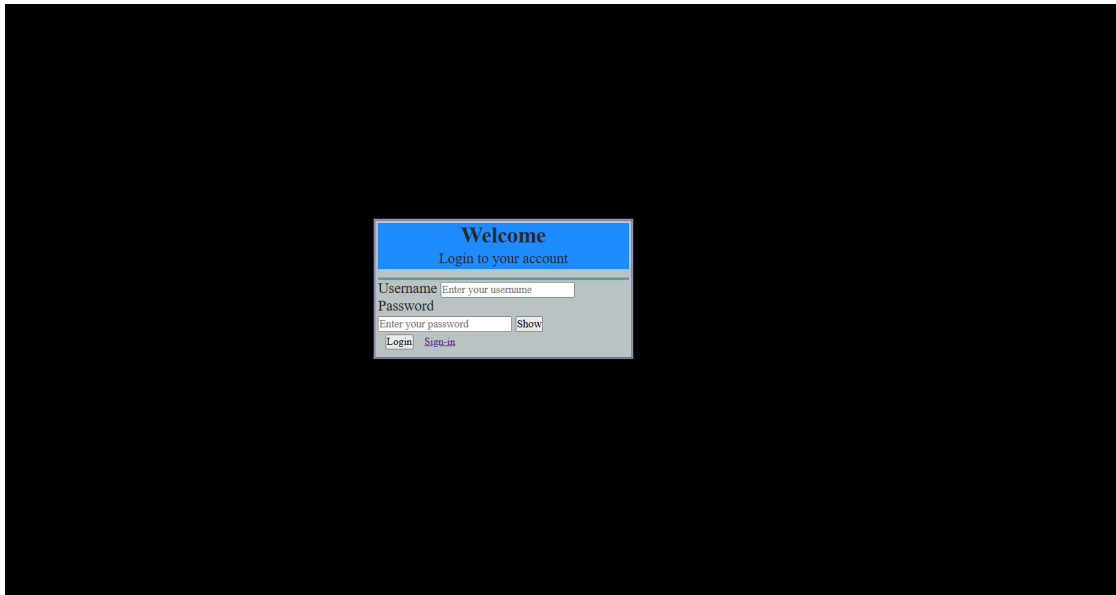


Figure 1 : Application Login Page

- Users who already have an account can log in directly. New users can create an account using the registration option.

3. User Registration

- New users must create an account before accessing the protected areas of the application.
- Select **Sign-in** from the Login page to open the registration page.
- The registration form requires:
 - Username
 - Email address
 - Password
 - Password confirmation
- The username must follow Django's username requirements.
- The password is validated using Django's built-in password validation rules.
- These include requirements such as:
 - The password should not be too similar to personal information.
 - The password must contain at least 8 characters.
 - The password should not be a commonly used password.
 - The password cannot be entirely numeric.

- After entering valid information, select **Register**.
- If registration is successful, a confirmation message is displayed and the user is redirected to the Login page.

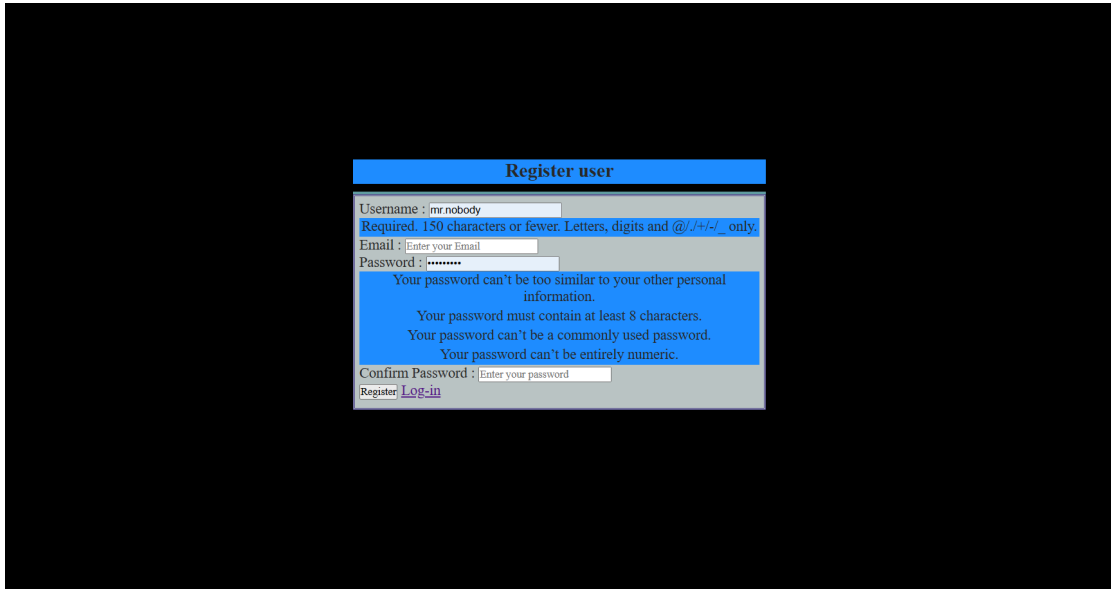


Figure 2 : Registration Page

Profile Creation

- After a new account is successfully created, a profile is automatically associated with the user.
- The user does not need to create the profile separately.

4. User Login

- Registered users can log in using their username and password.
- Enter:
 - Username
 - Password
- Then select **Login**.
- The application verifies the supplied credentials before allowing access to authenticated pages.

- If the credentials are incorrect, an appropriate message is displayed.

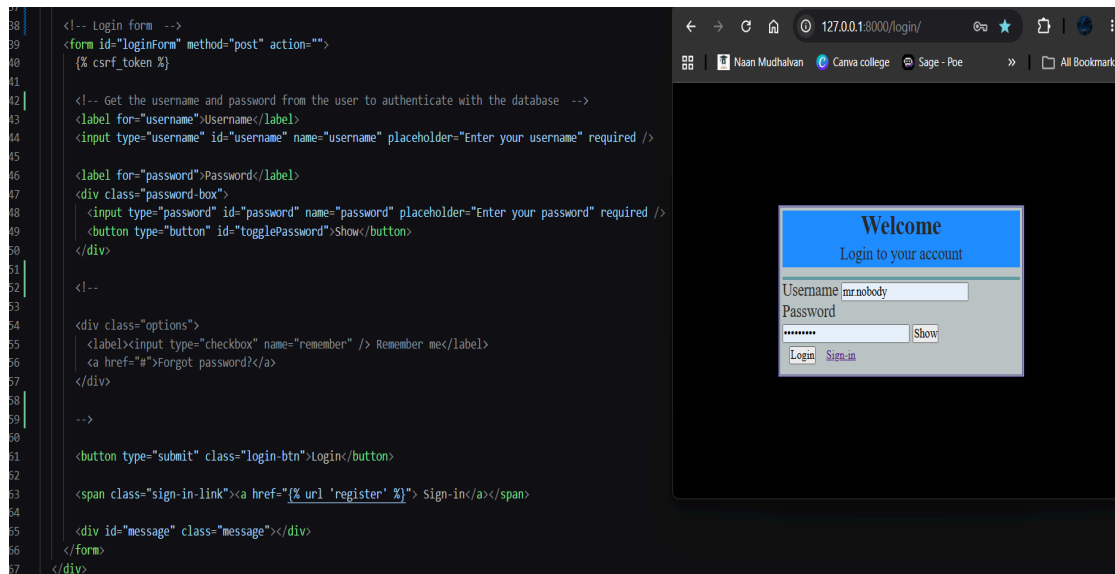


Figure 3 : Login Page with Login Form

After successful authentication, the user is redirected to the **Home** page.

5. Home Page

- The Home page is the starting page for authenticated users.
- The current version contains navigation options for accessing:
 - Profile
 - Posts
 - Logout
- The Home page is currently a placeholder for a future friend-based feed.
- Therefore, users should navigate to the **Posts** page to view the available posts.

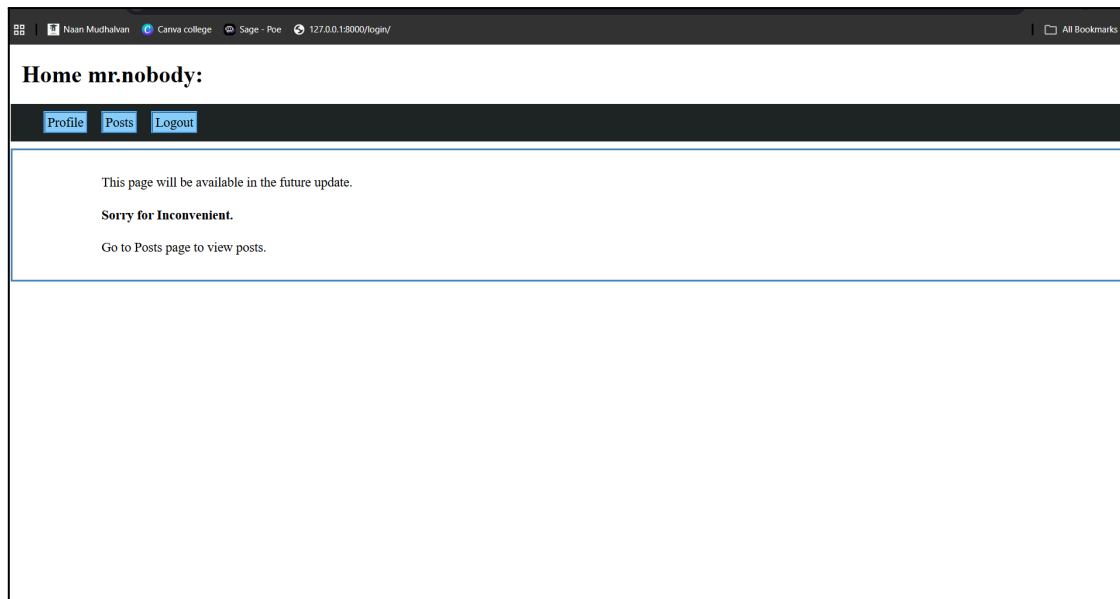


Figure 4 : Home Page

6. Profile Management

- The Profile section allows users to view and update their personal profile information.
- A profile is automatically created when the user account is registered.

6.1 Viewing Your Profile

- Select **Profile** from the navigation menu.
- The Profile page displays the user's available information, including:
 - Profile picture
 - Username
 - Private account status
 - Email
 - Bio
 - Gender
 - Date of birth
 - Phone number

- Website
- Location

➤ If a particular profile field has not been provided, it may appear empty.

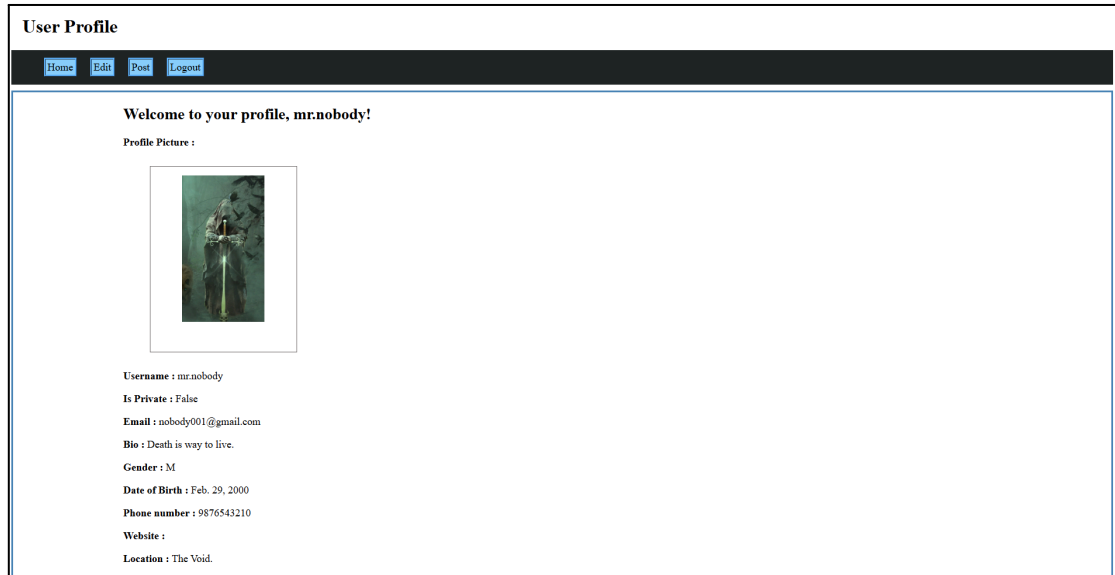


Figure 5 : Profile Page

➤ The Profile page also provides navigation to the Home page, Edit Profile page, Posts page, and Logout.

6.2 Editing Your Profile

Select **Edit** from the Profile page.

The Edit Profile page allows the user to modify their account and profile information.

The available fields include:

- Profile picture
- Username
- Email
- Private account option
- Bio
- Date of birth
- Gender

- Phone number
- Location
- Website

Editing mr.nobody's profile,

[Home](#) [Logout](#) [Back](#)

Profile picture:



[Choose File](#) | No file chosen

Username:

Is Private account: ☐

Email:

Bio:

Date of Birth:

Gender:

M - Male, F - Female, O - Other, PNS - Prefer Not to Say

Phone number:

Location:

Website:

[Save](#)

Figure 6 : Edit Profile Page

Profile Picture

A new profile picture can be selected using the file upload field.

The application accepts common image formats such as:

- PNG
- JPEG
- JPG

Bio

The profile bio can contain up to **255 characters**.

Gender

The available options are:

- M — Male
- F — Female

- O — Other
- PNS — Prefer Not to Say

Date of Birth

The application validates the date of birth before saving it.

The entered date:

- Cannot be in the future.
- Cannot represent an age greater than 100 years.
- Cannot represent an age below the application's minimum age requirement.

Private Account

- The **Is Private account** option allows the user to set their profile as private.
 - After making the required changes, select **Save**.
 - If changes are successfully saved, a confirmation message is displayed.
 - If no changes were made, the application informs the user that no changes were made.
 - If the supplied information is invalid, the application displays an appropriate warning.
-

7. Posts

The Posts section is the main area for viewing and interacting with posts.

Users can:

- View posts
 - Create posts
 - Edit their own posts
 - Delete their own posts
 - Like or unlike posts
 - Add comments
 - Delete their own comments
-

7.1 Viewing Posts

Select **Posts** from the navigation menu.

The Posts page displays available posts.

Each post can display:

- Profile picture of the post owner
- Username
- Title, when provided
- Post image, when provided
- Post content
- Creation date and time
- Edited date and time, when the post has been edited
- Like count
- Like status
- Comments

Posts are displayed with the most recent posts first.

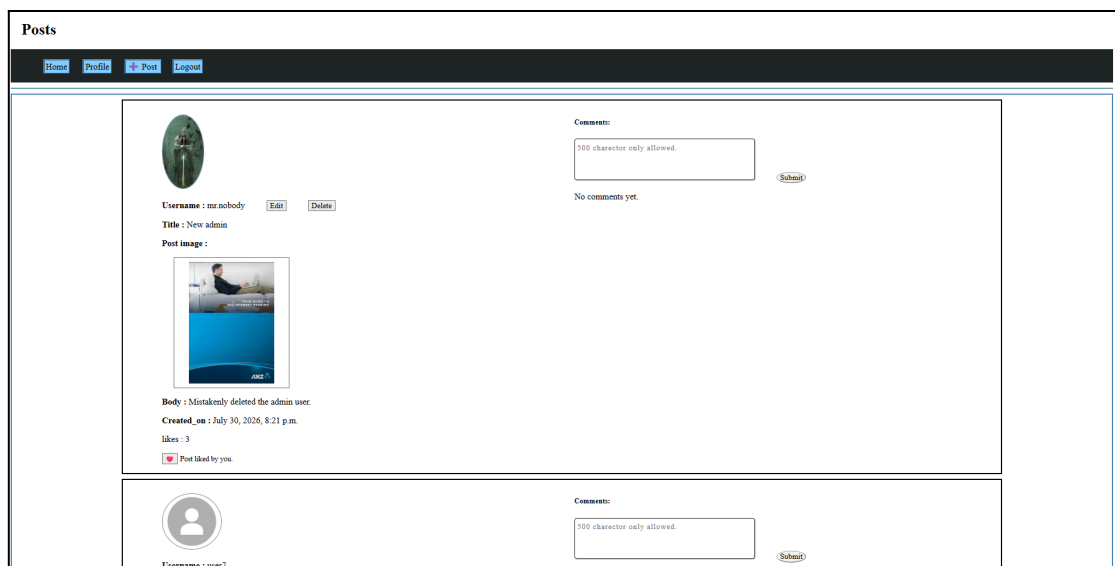


Figure 7 : Posts Page

Post Ownership

- Users can edit or delete a post only when they are the owner of that post.
- Edit and Delete controls are displayed for the user's own posts.

7.2 Creating a Post

- Select **+** **Post** from the Posts page.
- The Create Post page allows the user to create a new post.
- The available fields are:
 - Title — optional
 - Content — required
 - Image — optional
- The post content can contain up to **500 characters**.

New Post:

Home Back

mr.nobody's' Post creation,

Title :

Content * :

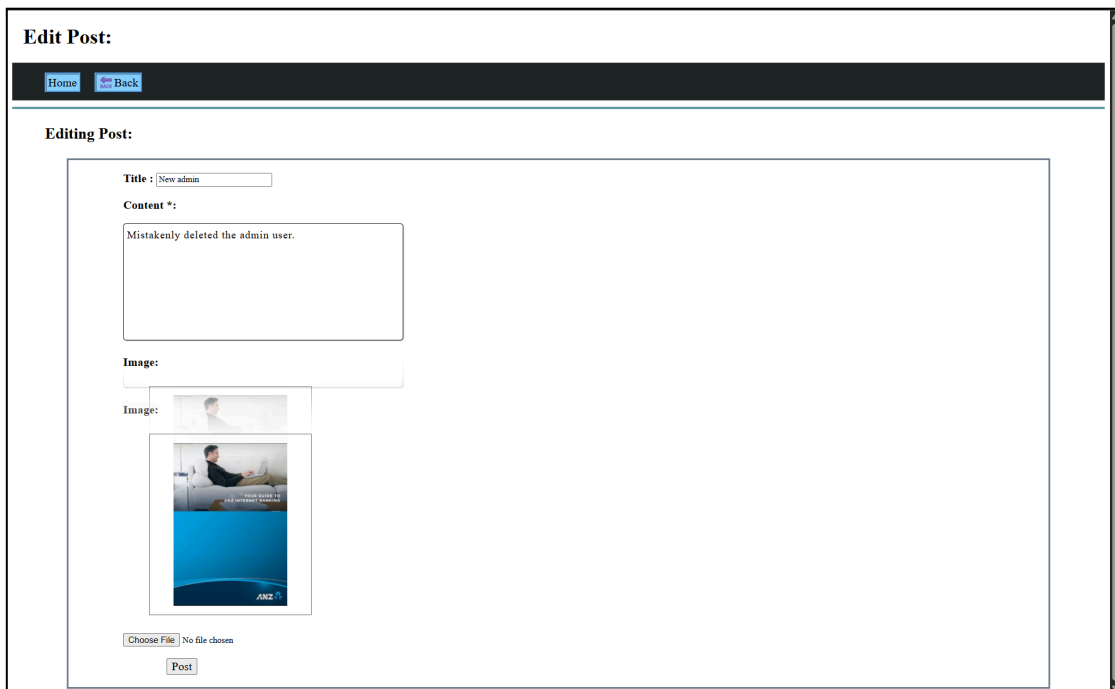
Image: FB_IMG_...4958481.jpg

Figure 8 : Create Post Page

- To add an image, select a supported image file using the image upload field.
 - Supported image formats include:
 - PNG
 - JPEG
 - JPG
 - After entering the required information, select **Post**.
 - The new post is then added to the Posts page.
-

7.3 Editing a Post

- Users can edit only their own posts.
- Select **Edit** on the post that needs to be modified.
- The Edit Post page displays the existing post information so that the user can modify it.
- The user can update:
 - Title
 - Post content
 - Post image



Edit Post:

[Home](#) [Back](#)

Editing Post:

Title :

Content *:

Mistakenly deleted the admin user.

Image:

Image:



No file chosen

Figure 9 : Edit Post Page

- The existing image is displayed when the post already contains an image.
 - After making the required changes, select **Post** to save the updated post.
 - An edited post displays its edited date and time.
-

7.4 Deleting a Post

- Users can delete only their own posts.
- Select **Delete** on the post that should be removed.
- Before the deletion is submitted, the application displays a confirmation dialog asking the user to confirm the action.

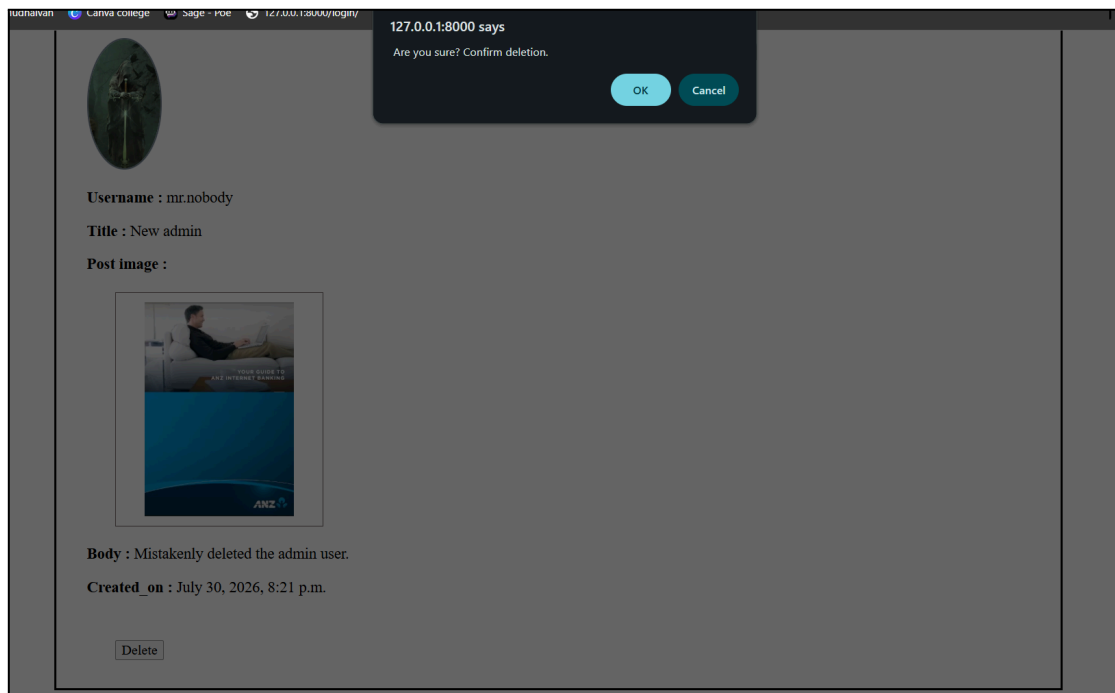


Figure 10 : Delete Confirmation Dialog

- Select **OK/Confirm** to continue with deletion.
- Select **Cancel** to stop the deletion.
- After confirmation, the post is deleted.

8. Likes

- Users can interact with posts using the Like button.
- The Posts page displays the current number of likes for each post.
- If the user has not liked a post, the like button is displayed in the unliked state.
- Select the button to like the post.

likes : 3 ☒ Post liked by you.	
 Username : user7 Title : Curious!! Body : How this place going to transform in future. Created_on : July 24, 2026, 10:27 p.m. Edited_on : July 31, 2026, 10:38 p.m. likes : 1 ☐	Comments: 500 charector only allowed. Submit user4 : Yeah, I'm looking forward to that day. 😊 commented on : July 31, 2026, 10:40 p.m.
 Username : samual Title : Invalidated profile	Comments: 500 charector only allowed. Submit mr.nobody : hello

Figure 11 : Unliked Post

- When the user has already liked a post, the button displays the liked state.
- Selecting the button again removes the user's like.

Created_on : July 30, 2026, 8:21 p.m. likes : 3 ☒ Post liked by you.	
 Username : user7 Body : It's great to talk with others. Created_on : July 25, 2026, 4:53 p.m. likes : 3 ☒ Post liked by you.	Comments: 500 charector only allowed. Submit mr.nobody : Yeah, that is really true. delete commented on : July 31, 2026, 8:47 p.m.
 Username : user7 Title : Curious!!	Comments: 500 charector only allowed. Submit user4 : Yeah, I'm looking forward to that day. 😊 commented on : July 31, 2026, 10:40 p.m.

Figure 12 : Liked Post

- The like count is updated according to the current number of likes.

9. Comments

- Users can add comments to posts from the Posts page.
- Each post contains a comment area with a text box.
- Enter the comment and select **Submit**.
- Comments can contain up to **500 characters**.

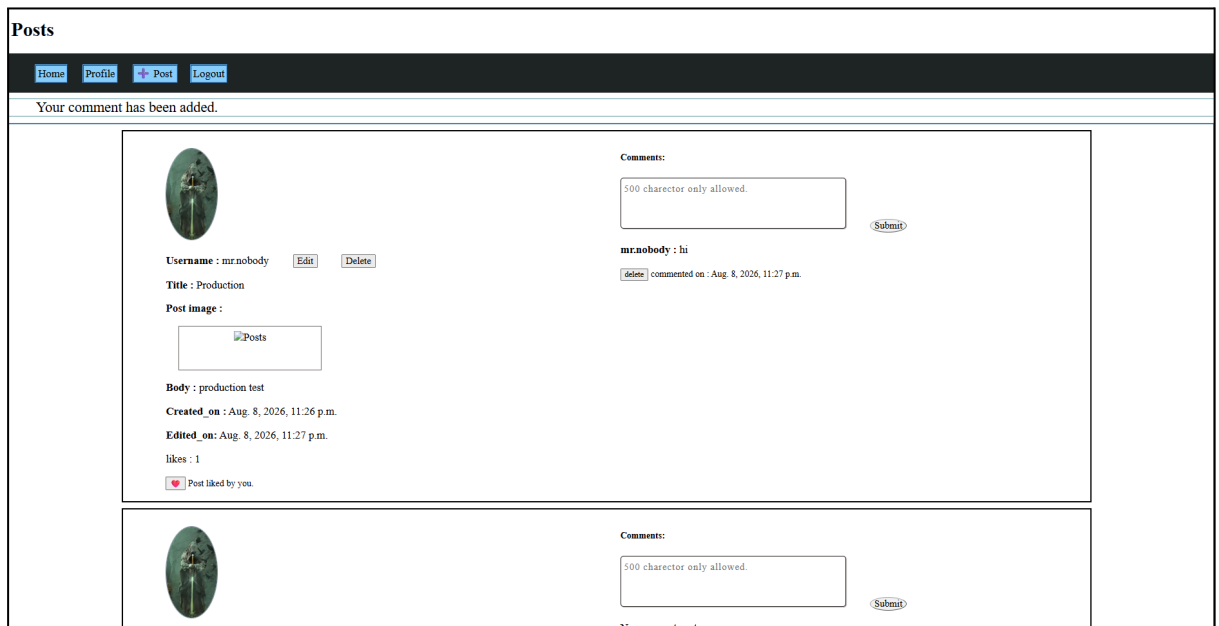


Figure 13 : Comment Section

- Existing comments are displayed below the comment input area.
- Each comment displays:
 - Commenter's username
 - Comment text
 - Comment creation date and time
- If a post does not have any comments, the application displays:

No comments yet.

Deleting a Comment

- A user can delete only their own comments.
- The **delete** option is displayed for comments owned by the currently authenticated user.

- Select **delete** to remove the comment.

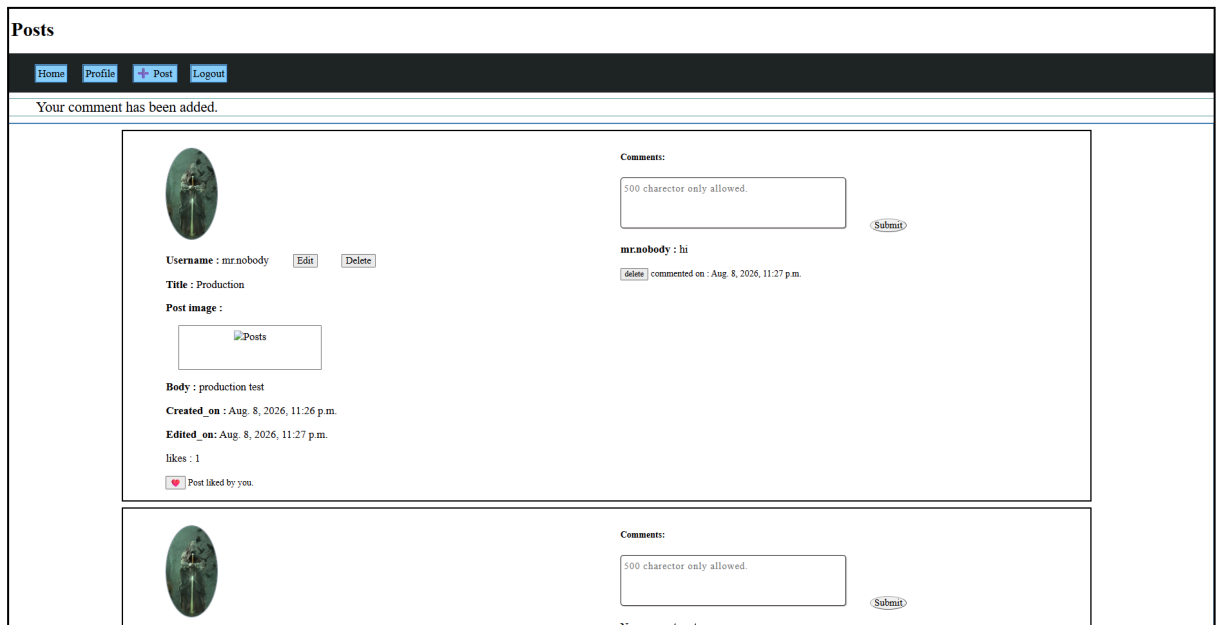


Figure 14 : Comment with Delete Option

[SCREENSHOT 14 — Comment with Delete Option]

10. Logging Out

- Users can log out using the **Logout** option available in the navigation menus.
- Selecting Logout ends the current authenticated session and redirects the user to the Login page.

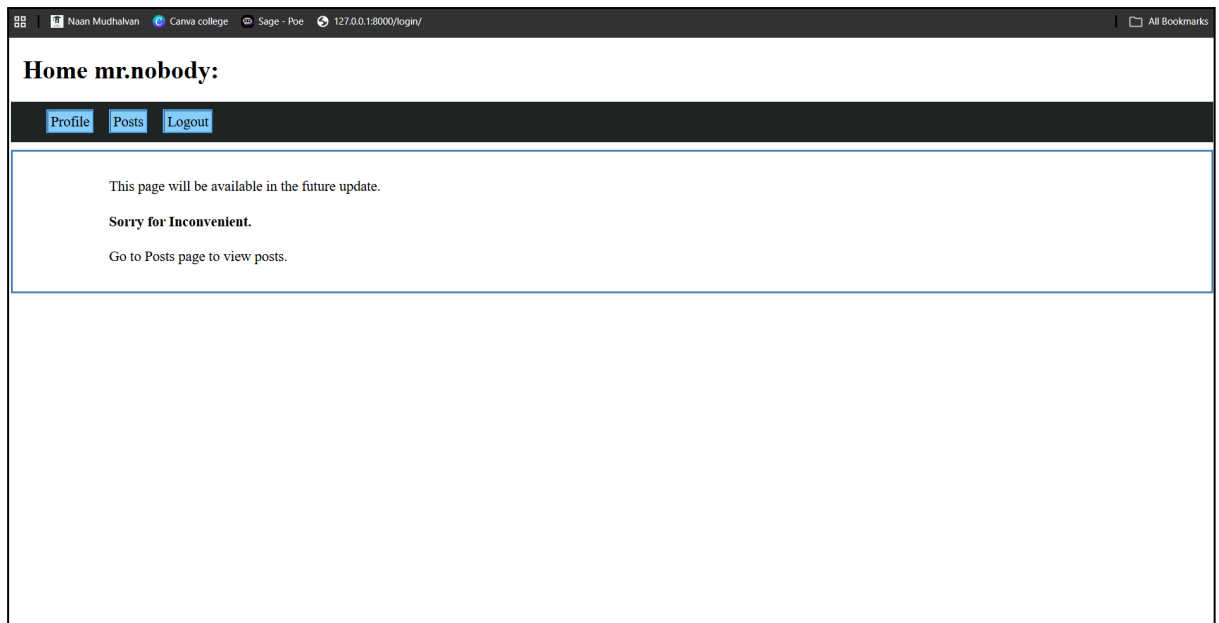


Figure 15 : Logout Navigation Option

- After logging out, protected pages require authentication before they can be accessed again.

11. Messages and Feedback

The application displays messages to provide feedback after certain actions.

Messages can indicate:

- Successful operations
- Invalid information
- Warning conditions
- No changes made

Examples include:

- **User has been created.**
- **Details modified!**
- **No changes made.**
- **Given data is invalid, check again!**
- **Username or Password incorrect.**

These messages appear within the application after the relevant action.

12. Current Limitations

The current v1.0 release does not include several features that may be added in future versions.

Friends

- The friends and friend-request system has not yet been implemented.
- Because of this, the Home page does not currently display a personalized feed based on friends.

Notifications

- Real-time notifications and WebSocket-based notifications are not currently available.

REST API

- A REST API has not been implemented in the current version.

Automated Testing

- Automated application tests have not been implemented in the current version.
- These features may be added in future updates.

13. Conclusion

The Django Social Media Platform v1.0 provides the core functionality required for users to create accounts, manage profiles, create and manage posts, and interact with posts through likes and comments.

The application is designed to be extended in future versions with additional social networking and backend capabilities.

This manual covers the features currently available in version 1.0.